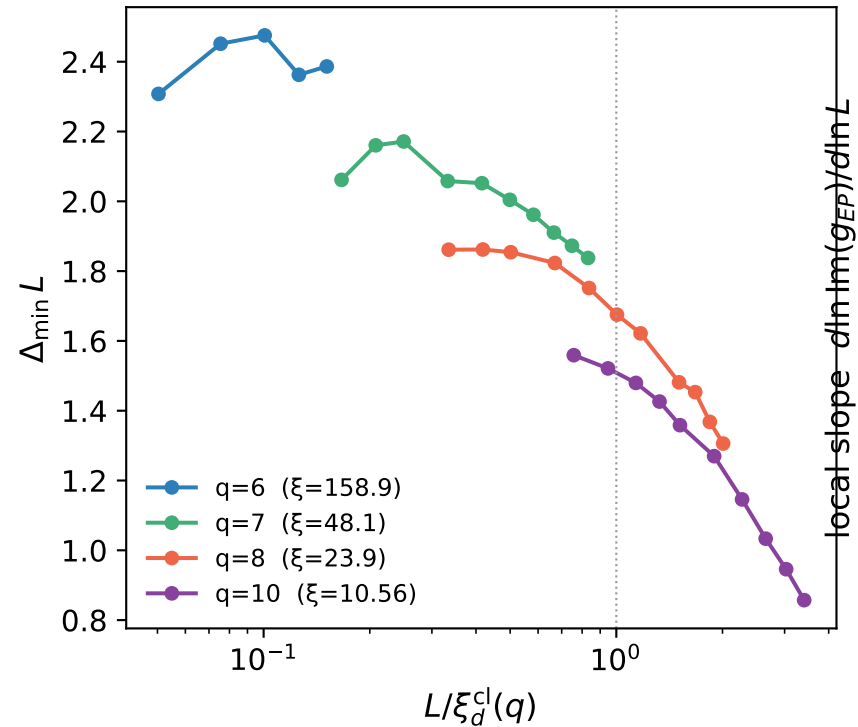


Walking crossover of the thermal-gap exceptional point (open-BC Z_q DMRG)

(a) gap amplitude: CFT-flat below ξ , decay beyond



(b) EP local slopes: runaway sets in at $L \sim \xi$

